

Standard Operating Procedure

Ambulance Dispatch, Checks and In-Transit Care

«Hospital Name» — Supports COP.3.e through COP.3.g

SOP No.	[Hospital to define]	Version	1.0
Effective Date	_____	Review Frequency	Annual, or on change
Prepared By	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved By	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how «Hospital Name» dispatches an ambulance, keeps it ready through daily checks, and delivers safe in-transit care with continuous communication.

2. Scope

Applies to every ambulance run by «Hospital Name», for emergency, inter-facility, and scheduled transport.

3. Responsibility

Ambulance Driver: completes daily vehicle-system checks and drives per the defined departure timeframe.

Ambulance Nurse/Paramedic: checks medical equipment and medication, and delivers in-transit care.

Control Room Staff: maintains continuous communication throughout the trip.

4. Procedure

4.1 Daily and post-trip checks

1. Complete daily checks of lights, siren, beacon, fuel, and tyres before the ambulance goes into service.
2. Check medical equipment and medication expiry daily, and top up consumables after every trip.

4.2 Dispatch

1. Log the call receipt time, and depart within the hospital's defined timeframe.
2. Maintain continuous wireless/mobile communication with the control room throughout the trip.

4.3 In-transit care

1. Open a patient file from the first communication with the referring point, capturing age, weight, provisional diagnosis, and ongoing treatment.
2. Name one person as responsible for in-transit clinical decisions for each trip.
3. Hand over to the receiving medical professional directly, with a complete verbal and written summary.

5. Records

Supported by Records 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, and 11 of the COP.3 Required Records pack.

6. Related Documents

- HCO_COP_3_v2_REWRITE_DRAFT — COP.3 policy

7. Review

Reviewed annually, and immediately after any ambulance-related adverse event.

8. References

- Automotive Research Association of India / Ministry of Road Transport and Highways, Government of India. (2014). AIS-125 (Part 1): Requirements for Ambulances Used for Transportation of Patients. <https://law.resource.org/pub/in/bis/ais/arai.in.ais.125-1.2014.pdf> — the National Ambulance Code referenced in the hospital's own ambulance classification records.